Mountain Division, he would have almost certainly accompanied Harbaksh and Hartley to Walong.

Adding to the confusion, Nehru reinstated Bijji Kaul as GOC IV Corps on 29 October, while Harbaksh Singh was ordered to replace Umrao Singh in XXXIII Corps. On that day itself, Kaul paid a quick visit to Walong. Two days later, Mohinder Pathania was shifted from 23 Infantry Division to 2 Mountain Division, which was assuming command of the Walong Sector with immediate effect. Hartley's 181 Infantry Brigade was also removed from Walong and replaced by 11 Infantry Brigade under Brigadier N. C. Rawlley.

Whoever coined the proverb about too many cooks spoiling the broth may well have been inspired by the haphazard way in which the command structure for Walong was tampered with. This sector, it must be remembered, along with Tawang, was originally set up towards the end of 1959. Three years later, in a period of ten days, with the Chinese having overrun Kibithu, four different command structures were set up at the brigade level, and, incredible as it may sound, under two different divisions.

Mohinder Pathania immediately asked 11 Brigade to set itself up in Walong. Rawlley, the moment he landed in Walong on 31 October, asked for more troops. He also set up his HQ there and made it clear that there would be 'no withdrawal from this place'. The 'surplus' 2/8 GR companies that were fighting with 4 Sikh at The Ladders and Mithun were now to be replaced by 3/3 GR, which had earlier pulled its Tac HQ back to Hayuliang on Harbaksh's orders. Rawlley also had at his disposal a troop each from 62 Para Field Battery and the 71 Heavy Mortar Battery.

Meanwhile, the Chinese, still stuck at the Ashi Hill bottleneck, were launching daily attacks at The Ladders and at Mithun, suffering severe casualties in the process. Unable to retrieve most of their dead, they saturated the killing ground with incendiary bombs during the daylight hours, which set fire to the grass and the vegetation. The Ladders and Mithun was being referred to as Tiger's Mouth.

Soon rumours started floating about radio intercepts of Chinese commanders asking their superiors if they could fall back to Rima. However, the daily attacks and the smoke and the stench of smouldering bodies were part of the Chinese plan to keep the Indian focus on The Ladders while they cut a path up the steep cliffs from Ashi Hill to Green Pimple, Yellow Pimple and Trijunction in an attempt to get above and then